

New Hire Onboarding Guide

Northwind Labs · People Operations · First 30 days

Welcome to Northwind Labs. This guide walks you through your first month. It points to the policies that own the details · time off, remote work, security, expenses, and benefits · so treat it as a checklist and a map, not the final word on any single rule.

Day One

- Collect your company laptop from IT; confirm full-disk encryption and automatic screen lock are enabled before you sign in to anything.
- Set up single sign-on and enroll in multi-factor authentication · you will need MFA for nearly every system.
- Install and test the company-approved VPN; you must be on it to reach internal systems when working remotely.
- Meet your manager and review your team's core collaboration hours.

Week One

- Enroll in benefits within your 30-day window: medical, dental, vision, and the 401(k) with its employer match.
- Read the Paid Time Off Policy so you know how PTO accrues, how much can roll over, and the notice your team expects.
- Read the Remote Work Policy for how many remote days are allowed and the approval path with your manager.
- Skim the Travel and Expense Policy before your first purchase so you submit receipts correctly and route approvals.

First 30 Days

By the end of your first month you should have completed security awareness training, submitted any home-office stipend request with manager approval, set your 401(k) contribution, and had a first check-in with your manager. If anything about a policy is unclear, ask in the relevant channel · #people, #security, or #finance · rather than guessing.

Your Onboarding Buddy and Manager

Every new hire is paired with an onboarding buddy · an experienced teammate, separate from your manager, who answers the small questions that are awkward to escalate. Your manager owns your ramp plan and your first goals; your buddy helps you navigate the tools, the channels, and the unwritten norms. Expect a short daily check-in with your buddy in week one and a weekly one-on-one with your manager from the start.

Tools You Will Use

Tool	Purpose	Set up by
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SSO + MFA	Sign in to everything	Day one, with IT
VPN client	Reach internal systems	Day one, with IT
People portal	Time off, benefits	Week one
Expense tool	Receipts and reimbursement	Before first purchase
Password manager	Service credentials	Day one

Common First-Week Questions

How much time off do I get, and can it roll over? How many days a week can I work remotely? Who approves my expenses? What do I do if I think I clicked a phishing link? Each of these has a precise answer in a dedicated policy · this guide deliberately does not restate the numbers, because policies change and the guide should not drift out of sync. Always confirm the figure in the owning policy below.

Where the Rules Actually Live

- Paid time off, rollover, and notice: Paid Time Off Policy.
- Remote days, core hours, VPN: Remote Work Policy.
- Encryption, MFA, production access, incident reporting: Security Policy and the Information Security Guidelines.
- Limits, per-diems, and approvals: Travel and Expense Policy.
- Insurance, retirement, leave programs, and the learning budget: Benefits Guide.

A Note on Asking Questions

No question is too small in your first month. The fastest way to ramp is to ask early and in the open, so the answer helps the next new hire too. If you are unsure which channel to use, ask your buddy · routing you to the right place is exactly what they are there for.